

ENG513 SHORT HANDOUTS

MIDTERM

Lesson 01 to 05

(ENG513) Language Teaching Methods

EFFORT BY VUHELPERS24 TEAM

REGARDS : SIR ZAHID: 03342743020

Lesson-01

LANGUAGE: SOME THEORETICAL CONCEPTS

Topic-001: Defining Language

What is the significance of language in human life?

Language is essential to human existence, permeating every aspect of our experiences and shaping our perception of the world. It is an integral part of human life.

Who made the observation that "A definition of language is always, implicitly or explicitly, a definition of human beings in the world"?

This observation was made by the British cultural critic, Raymond Williams.

Why is language often considered an "unknown object" even by experts in the field?

Language is considered an "unknown object" because, despite extensive study, its complexity and true nature remain elusive and not fully understood.

Topic-002: Some Theoretical Concepts: Language as a System

How can language be broadly categorized for understanding its relevance?

Language can be categorized into three broad conceptual vantage points: language as a system, language as discourse, and language as ideology.

What are the core components of language as a system?

The core components of language as a system include the phonological system, the semantic system, and the syntactic system.

What is the term for the distinct sound units that can change the meaning of a word in a language?

The distinct sound units that can change the meaning of a word in a language are called phonemes.

How does language as a system enable the formation of sentences and texts?

Language as a system enables language users to combine phonemes to form words, words to form phrases, phrases to form sentences, and sentences to form spoken or written texts following specific rules.

What concept did Chomsky introduce to explain the ability of humans to produce an infinite number of sentences using a finite set of rules?

Chomsky introduced the concept of "Universal Grammar," which is a set of abstract principles and parameters governing the grammatical structure of all human languages.

What is the difference between linguistic competence and linguistic performance, according to Chomsky?

Linguistic competence refers to a speaker-hearer's knowledge of their language, while linguistic performance relates to the actual use of language in specific situations, including the effects of memory, attention, and other factors.

Topic-003: Some Theoretical Concepts: Language as Discourse

What is the definition of discourse in linguistics?

In linguistics, discourse refers to an instance of spoken or written language that has describable internal relationships of form and meaning, which relate coherently to an external communicative function and audience.

Who introduced the concept of communicative competence?

Dell Hymes introduced the concept of communicative competence, which encompasses both knowledge and ability for using language in real-life situations.

What are the components of Hymes' SPEAKING model for communicative competence?

The components of the SPEAKING model include Setting, Participants, Ends, Act sequence, Key, Instrumentalities, Norms, and Genre.

How does Austin define a speech act?

A speech act is defined by Austin as a combination of three components: locution (the propositional statement), illocution (the intended meaning), and perlocution (the expected response).

Why is context important in understanding illocutionary force?

Context is crucial in understanding illocutionary force because it determines the meaning of a speech act. The same utterance can have different illocutionary forces based on the situational context.

What is the main focus of discourse analysis as a field of study?

Discourse analysis focuses on studying language use in context, examining the relationships between form and meaning, and how language is used in communicative situations.

Topic 004: Language as an Ideology

What is ideology, as defined in the context of language?

Ideology is a systematic body of ideas organized from a particular point of view, closely connected to power and domination.

How did Thompson define ideology in "Ideology and Modern Culture"?

Thompson defined ideology as "meaning in the service of power" and emphasized that studying ideology involves understanding how meaning serves to establish and sustain relations of domination.

According to Kroskrity, what are the dimensions of language ideologies?

Kroskrity's dimensions of language ideologies include the perception of language and discourse tied to specific social or cultural groups, the multiplicity of perspectives within sociocultural groups, varying degrees of awareness of local language ideologies, and the mediation between social structures and forms of talk.

How does Michel Foucault conceptualize discourse?

Michel Foucault sees discourse as the entire conceptual territory on which knowledge is produced and reproduced, encompassing language and determining what can be said, heard, silenced, accepted, or tabooed.

Topic 005: Language Teaching and Theoretical Concepts about Language

How do theories of language relate to language teaching?

Theories of language provide the foundation for understanding language and its acquisition, which directly influences teaching methods and approaches.

What role do language acquisition theories play in language teaching?

Language acquisition theories, such as behaviorism, nativism, and social interactionist theories, guide teachers in choosing effective teaching methods based on how learners acquire a second language.

How does applied linguistics bridge the gap between linguistic theory and language teaching?

Applied linguistics focuses on the practical application of linguistic theories in language classrooms, addressing areas like curriculum design, language assessment, and teacher training.

Give an example of how theoretical concepts impact language teaching methodologies.

The choice of language teaching methods, such as Communicative Language Teaching or Task-Based Language Teaching, is influenced by specific beliefs about language and language learning.

How do theoretical concepts inform the development of language teaching materials?

Theoretical concepts guide the creation of textbooks, multimedia resources, and online tools tailored to support language learning.

Why is understanding theoretical concepts about language essential for teacher education programs?

Teacher education programs incorporate linguistic and pedagogical theories to prepare educators for effective language instruction, helping them make informed teaching decisions.

Sir Zahid

Lesson No:2

A BRIEF HISTORY OF LANGUAGE TEACHING METHODS

Topic-006: Language Teaching Methods Course and its Significance

What are language teaching methods?

Language teaching methods are a set of teaching practices, approaches, and materials used to facilitate foreign language learning.

How have language teaching methods changed over time?

Language teaching methods have evolved throughout history, adapting to changing goals and values in language learning.

What disciplines have influenced language teaching methods?

Linguistics, literature studies, education, and psychology have informed language teaching methods.

How have different skills and priorities in language teaching methods changed over history?

Different historical periods have prioritized various language skills such as listening comprehension, speaking, reading, and writing based on the needs of learners and societal values. For example, some eras focused on reading for academic purposes, while others emphasized oral communication.

Topic-007: Language Teaching Methods in Ancient Times

Who were the ancient Greeks and Romans interested in language teaching for?

The ancient Greeks were interested in language teaching for understanding the mind, while the Romans studied foreign languages, particularly Greek, for practical purposes.

What were the primary focuses of language teaching in ancient times?

In ancient times, languages were primarily taught for reading or oral communication, depending on the era.

What were the language teaching methods in ancient times, and how did the Greeks and Romans approach foreign language learning?

In ancient times, the Greeks and Romans were among the earliest to consider foreign language teaching. The Greeks were interested in language learning for philosophical reasons. The Romans studied languages like Greek for practical communication. Their approaches were often influenced by the goals and values of their respective societies.

Topic-008: Language Teaching Methods in Europe in Early Modern Times

How did language teaching methods change in Europe during the 17th, 18th, and 19th centuries?

Language teaching in Europe during this time was associated with teaching Latin and Greek, focusing on grammatical rules, syntactic structures, and rote memorization.

What method emerged from the Classical Method in the 19th century?

The Classical Method evolved into the Grammar-Translation Method, which emphasized understanding grammatical rules during translation.

How did language teaching methods in Europe change in the 17th to 19th centuries, and why was there a strong focus on grammar and translation?

In the 17th to 19th centuries, the teaching of Latin and Greek became prominent in Europe. There was an emphasis on grammar, syntactic structures, rote memorization, and the translation of literary texts. These methods were not meant for oral communication but aimed to make learners "scholarly" or knowledgeable.

Topic-009: Language Teaching Methods in the 19th and Early to Mid-20th Century

What was the dominant language teaching method in Europe from the 1840s to the 1940s?

The dominant method during this period was the Grammar-Translation Method.

Who were some of the reformers in language teaching in the 19th century?

Reformers like C. Marcel, F. Gouin, and T. Pendergast introduced ideas such as understanding meaning in language learning and presenting language in context.

What was the Grammar-Translation Method, and why did it dominate language teaching in Europe for a century?

The Grammar-Translation Method focused on teaching language through a deep understanding of grammatical rules, translation, and vocabulary memorization. It was widely used because it aligned with the traditional academic objectives of teaching languages for reading and intellectual development.

Topic-010: Language Teaching Methods from the Mid- to Late-20th Century

How did Noam Chomsky's theories challenge traditional language teaching methods?

Chomsky's theories, like Transformational Generative Grammar, challenged behaviorist models and led to a shift in how language was taught.

What is the Input Hypothesis proposed by Stephen Krashen?

The Input Hypothesis suggests that language is acquired through comprehensible input slightly beyond the learner's present proficiency.

What is the Communicative Language Teaching approach?

Communicative Language Teaching focuses on teaching communicative competence, emphasizing fluency, accuracy, and real-world language use.

What are the basic principles of Communicative Language Teaching, and how does it differ from traditional language teaching methods?

Communicative Language Teaching emphasizes communicative competence, combining fluency and accuracy, and uses language in real-life contexts. It differs from traditional methods by focusing on the practical use of language and meaningful communication.

Why has there been a disillusionment with the traditional methods debate in language teaching, and what trends have emerged in recent years?

The traditional methods debate has become inconclusive due to the evolving nature of language learning. Recent trends include greater authenticity in language learning activities and a deeper understanding of the language learning process.

Lesson-03

DIFFERENCE IN THEORY APPROACH METHOD TECHNIQUE

Topic-011: What is a Theory?

What is a theory and how is it developed?

A theory is a set of statements developed through continued abstractions aimed at explaining a phenomenon.

Is it generally agreed that teachers' classroom practice is based on theory?

Yes, it is generally agreed that teachers' classroom practice is based on some theory, whether explicitly articulated or not.

How is common sense related to theory in education?

Common sense is seen as not substantially different from theory, differing mainly in the formality and self-consciousness with which it is invoked.

What are the questions that have become controversial in the field of education regarding theory?

Questions such as what constitutes a theory, who constructs a theory, and whose theory counts as theory have become controversial.

What is the traditional separation between theory and practice in education?

In the context of L2 education, theory is generally seen as insights and concepts derived from academic disciplines, while practice involves teaching and learning strategies.

What is the distinction between professional theory and personal theory of education?

A professional theory is widely known and understood, transmitted through teacher training, while a personal theory is individually developed through experience.

Why do critical pedagogists criticize the teacher-as-implementer approach?

Critical pedagogists argue that it forces teachers to take orders from established theorists and leaves little room for self-conceptualization and self-construction of personal theories.

How does Alexander differentiate between theory as product and theory as process?

Theory as product refers to content knowledge, while theory as process refers to the intellectual activity needed to theorize.

According to Alexander, what should a teacher's theory of practice be based on?

A teacher's theory of practice should be based on speculative theory, empirical research findings, and experiential knowledge, without privileging any one source.

What are the three levels of teacher theorizing, as differentiated by Donald McIntyre?

The three levels are technical, practical, and critical (or emancipatory) levels of theorizing.

Topic-012: Theories of Language in Language Teaching

What are the three theoretical views of language that inform language teaching approaches?

The three views are the structural view, the functional view, and the interactional view.

How does the structural view define language?

The structural view sees language as a system of structurally related elements for the coding of meaning.

What is the focus of the functional view of language?

The functional view emphasizes language as a vehicle for the expression of functional meaning and communication.

What is the interactional view of language?

The interactional view sees language as a tool for the creation and maintenance of social relations and interpersonal transactions.

How does a notional syllabus differ from a structural one?

A notional syllabus specifies language content based on topics, notions, and concepts, focusing on meaning and function rather than structure.

How does the ESP movement approach language teaching content?

The ESP movement begins with a functional account of learner needs, focusing on specific purposes rather than structural language elements.

What does the interactional perspective in language education emphasize?

The interactional perspective emphasizes that students achieve language proficiency when their attention is focused on conveying and receiving authentic messages in situations of importance.

What are the central areas of inquiry for interactional theories of language teaching?

Interactional theories draw on interaction analysis, conversation analysis, and ethnomethodology to understand patterns of exchange and interaction in language learning.

How do structural, functional, or interactional models of language inform teaching methods?

These models provide the theoretical framework that may motivate specific teaching methods, such as Audio-lingualism.

Why do theories of language learning need to complement theoretical views of language in teaching?

Theoretical views of language in teaching need to be complemented by theories of language learning to provide a complete framework for effective language instruction.

Topic-013: What is a Method/Methodology?

What is the difference between a method and a methodology in language teaching?

A method is a specific application of an approach in language teaching, while a methodology is the rationale for the selection of a set of tools and describes the general research strategy.

Topic-014: Types of Methods

What are the three main categories of language teaching methods?

The three main categories of language teaching methods are language-centered methods, learner-centered methods, and learning-centered methods.

Topic-015: Some other terms: System, Procedure, Technique

How is the term "system" used in systemic functional linguistics (SFL)?

In SFL, "system" can refer to language as a whole, and it represents language as an open, dynamic system.

What is the definition of a linguistic procedure in language teaching?

A linguistic procedure refers to a series of actions conducted in a certain order or manner, and it relates to the cognitive processes involved in language production and comprehension.

What is the definition of a technique in language teaching?

A technique in language teaching is a specific trick, stratagem, or contrivance used to accomplish an immediate objective in a classroom, and it should be consistent with the method and approach.

What is the role of theory in language teaching?

In language teaching, theory is a system of assumptions, principles, and relationships used to explain a specific set of language learning and teaching phenomena.

Lesson-04

**CONTEXT OF ENGLISH LANGUAGE AND LTM IN
PAKISTAN**

Topic-016: Status of English in Pakistan

What is the status of English in Pakistan?

English is primarily a symbol of prestige and high social class in Pakistan.

What were the original expectations regarding English in Pakistan?

English was expected to continue as the official language until national languages replaced it.

What has contributed to the continued importance of English in Pakistan?

Social and political factors have played a major role in maintaining the superiority of the English language.

Topic-017: English Language and Education in Pakistan

What was the historical context of English in the sub-continent?

English has a historical background in the Indian subcontinent, dating back to colonial times.

What is the role of English in higher education in Pakistan?

English serves as both the official language and the medium of instruction in higher education in Pakistan.

What challenges are faced in English language teaching in Pakistan?

Challenges include poor results in English language proficiency, flawed pedagogy, and a lack of linguistic support in higher education.

Topic-018: Teaching and Learning of English in Pakistan

How is English typically taught in Pakistani schools?

English is often taught through grammar drills and vocabulary memorization, with limited emphasis on communication skills.

What should English language teaching encompass beyond grammar and vocabulary?

It should include a broader communicative concept, emphasizing the ability to communicate effectively and not just grammar.

What challenges do English teachers and students face in higher education?

Challenges include the use of L1 (native language) as the medium of instruction and a lack of confidence and competence in English language teaching.

Topic-019: English Language Curriculum in Pakistan

How are language policy goals transmitted through curriculum and textbooks in Pakistan?

Language policy goals are transmitted through the curriculum and textbooks, which influence what is taught in the classroom.

Why do teachers often feel limited in their ability to bring innovation to the curriculum?

Teachers often believe that the curriculum is handed down to them and cannot be changed, restricting their room for innovation.

What is the effect of using a curriculum that transcends students' comprehension?

A curriculum that is too complex can hinder students' understanding and preparation for classroom communication.

Topic-020: LTM and Constraints in Pakistan

What constraints are faced in English Language Teaching (ELT) in Pakistan?

Constraints include inadequate resources, overcrowded classes, unenthusiastic teachers, and the influence of religious, cultural, social, and political circumstances.

What teaching method is still prevalent in Pakistan, despite changing trends?

The grammar translation method (GTM) is still widely used in Pakistan and other parts of the world.

How do language teachers in Pakistan tend to teach, and what are the consequences?

Many teachers in Pakistan use the GTM, which emphasizes rules and exceptions, leading to poor communication and creative skills development.

What are the constraints in English Language Teaching in Pakistan?

Constraints include inadequate resources, overcrowded classes, and unenthusiastic teachers who restrict the adoption of effective teaching methodologies.

What teaching method is still prevalent in Pakistan, and what issues does it bring?

The grammar translation method (GTM) is still widely used, but it emphasizes rules and exceptions, leading to poor communication and creative skills development.

Lesson:05

CONTEXT OF ENGLISH LANGUAGE AND LTM IN PAKISTAN-PART 2

Topic-021: Teaching Speaking and Listening in Pakistan

What is the order of learning language skills, and which comes first?

Listening comes first, followed by speaking. Reading and writing come later.

What are some issues related to speaking and listening in the Pakistani context?

Some issues include the role of social context, influence of the first language, and a lack of emphasis on teaching and evaluating speaking and listening skills.

Why should communicative needs be reconsidered in Pakistan?

English is used globally, and it's important to address the communication needs and roles that individuals are expected to perform.

What are some concerns regarding teaching speaking and listening in Pakistan?

Concerns include classroom resources, unmotivated teachers, disinterested students, inadequate curriculum, and a lack of teachers and textbooks.

What are some of the issues related to teaching speaking and listening in the Pakistani context?

Pakistan, issues include the influence of the first language, a lack of emphasis on teaching and evaluating speaking and listening skills, and concerns related to classroom resources, teacher motivation, and student interest.

Topic-022: Teaching Reading in Pakistan

Why is teaching reading in English significant in Pakistan?

Teaching reading in English is crucial due to the prominence of English as a lingua franca.

What are some challenges in teaching reading in the Pakistani context?

Challenges include the linguistic situation, the use of the Grammar Translation method, and a lack of teacher training.

What is intensive reading, and why is it important?

Intensive reading is a focused reading approach that helps students develop a deeper understanding of the text. It is essential for comprehension and critical analysis.

Topic-023: Teaching Writing in Pakistan

Why is writing in English significant in Pakistan?

Writing in English is important for educated individuals, professionals, and the elite class in Pakistan.

What challenges are associated with teaching and learning writing in English in Pakistan?

Challenges include the situation in educational institutions, teaching practices, teacher training, and the examination system.

Topic-024: ELT, Use of Methods, and SL Proficiency in Pakistan

What traditional method is primarily used for English language teaching in Pakistan?

The primary method used is the Grammar Translation method.

How does the focus on literature-based content impact language skills in Pakistan?

The focus on literature often takes precedence over language skills, resulting in lower proficiency in speaking and listening.

What factors contribute to low English proficiency in Pakistan?

Answer: Bifurcated education streams, method choices, differences between public and private schools, a strong emphasis on reading and writing, and de-contextualized teaching and learning contribute to low proficiency.

Why is there a low proficiency in English in Pakistan, and what are some contributing factors?

Factors contributing to low proficiency include bifurcated education streams, traditional teaching methods, differences between public and private schools, a focus on reading and writing over speaking and listening, and de-contextualized teaching and learning of English.

Topic-025: ELT and Teacher Training in Pakistan

What was the objective of the English Language Teaching Reforms (ELTR) project in Pakistan?

The ELTR project aimed to build the capacity of English language teachers in higher education for effective teaching and research.

What are some objectives of the ELTR project's professional development programs?

The objectives include training English faculty for professional development, enhancing research capacity, integrating technology with ELT, and improving expertise in testing techniques.

How does the project aim to enhance English faculty's expertise?

The project involves training in computer-assisted language learning (CALL) and setting up Self Access Centers (SAC) in universities. It also organizes visits of

international experts to share different models for the education system in Pakistan.

Working on the Next Lessons

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